BDD also reduces wasted effort by enabling faster, more useful feedback to users. This helps teams make changes sooner rather than later.

1.4.2 Reduced costs

The direct consequence of this reduced waste is to reduce costs. By focusing on building features with demonstrable business value (building the right software), and not wasting effort on features of little value, you can reduce the cost of delivering a viable product to your users. And by improving the quality of the application code (building the software right), you reduce the number of bugs, and therefore the cost of fixing these bugs, as well as the cost associated with the delays these bugs would cause.

1.4.3 Easier and safer changes

BDD makes it considerably easier to change and extend your applications. Living documentation is generated from the executable specifications using terms that stakeholders are familiar with. This makes it much easier for stakeholders to understand what the application actually does. The low-level executable specifications also act as technical documentation for developers, making it easier for them to understand the existing code base and to make their own changes.

Last, but certainly not least, BDD practices produce a comprehensive set of automated acceptance and unit tests, which reduces the risk of regressions caused by any new changes to the application.

1.4.4 Faster releases

These comprehensive automated tests also speed up the release cycle considerably. Testers are no longer required to carry out long manual testing sessions before each new release. Instead, they can use the automated acceptance tests as a starting point, and spend their time more productively and efficiently on exploratory tests and other nontrivial manual tests.

1.5 Disadvantages and potential challenges of BDD

While its benefits are significant, introducing BDD into an organization isn't always without its difficulties. In this section, we'll look at a few situations where introducing BDD can be more of a challenge.

1.5.1 BDD requires high business engagement and collaboration

BDD practices are based on conversation and feedback. Indeed, these conversations drive and build the team's understanding of the requirements and of how they can deliver business value based on these requirements. If stakeholders are unwilling or unable to engage in conversations and collaboration, or they wait until the end of the project before giving any feedback, it will be hard to draw the full benefits of BDD.